The query is provided as an argument to the `-d` parameter. Note that the entire query (beginning with `Content-Type`) is enclosed in single quotes when sending the request via cURL.

8.7.3 Query DSL for aggregations

Although we haven't yet introduced the analytics part of Elasticsearch, here's a quick primer. With Query DSL, we use a similar format for aggregations (analytics), with an `aggs` (short for *aggregations*) object instead of a `query` object. The following listing shows this format.

Listing 8.14 Aggregation query written in Query DSL format

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "size": 0,
  "aggs": {
    "average_movie_rating": {
      "avg": {
        "field": "rating"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

This query fetches the average rating of all movies using a metric aggregation called `avg` (short for *average*). Now that we understand the overall form for Query DSL, let's look more at leaf and compound queries, which we touched on earlier.

8.7.4 Leaf and compound queries

Query DSL supports both leaf and compound queries. The body of the search query can accept simple or complex query criteria.

A *leaf query* is straightforward, with no clauses. Such queries fetch results based on certain criteria (for example, getting top-rated movies, movies released during a particular year, the gross earnings of a movie, and so on).

With leaf queries, we can find results for criteria against certain fields. The following listing shows an example. (Don't worry about the contents of the query; we discuss such queries in depth in the next few chapters.)

Listing 8.15 Leaf query that matches a phrase

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "query": {
    "match_phrase": {
      "synopsis": "A meek hobbit from the shire and eight companions"
    }
  }
}
```